The Plan of Salvation

Purpose: *To show that salvation is by Grace alone through faith alone to the Glory of God alone.*

Centred on: *The problem and the solution.*

KEEP IT SIMPLE! The purpose of this study is not just information. It's transformation!

Humanity longs for a saviour. We're infatuated with superheroes: superman, batman, ironman, spider man. The longing is genuine and correct, but we need more than a physical deliverance from a physical problem by physical violence.

Genesis 1: 1-31… Mankind bears moral, mental, and emotional image of God Open fellowship with God, Unashamed, guilt-free, and loving interaction.

Genesis 3:1- 8… Suddenly there is Guilt/shame due to the disloyalty. Would they have felt this way back in Genesis 1? (Adam is the Hebrew word for Mankind)

Satan tells a series of lies (the serpent)

Verse 1 = Relationship of **restriction** not freedom.

Verse 4 = The Lies of SATAN – God's word is unclear, he is keeping something from you. You will not surely die! **God has lied!**

Verse 5 = **God is self serving** and doesn't really have your best interest at heart, he doesn't love you.

Verse 8 shows a break of relationship. Read 2:17

Before the act of sin was committed, a false picture of God was installed in the human heart. As a result, trust was broken, which then gave way to the behavioural rebellion.

Question: Was this just an isolated incident that took place in a garden so long ago?

Genesis 3:7-13… Five vital insights

1. Shame, now they had become sinners, and as a result their entire orientation shifted toward selfishness.

2. Fear, The shame they now felt for their sin was transposed over their newly adopted picture of God, creating a sense of apprehension toward Him. They now saw their Maker as a self-serving tyrant, which generated an unnatural fear of God. The One they had loved and trusted now appeared to present a threat to them. In their state of delusion they imagined that the guilt they felt in their hearts was the result of God's attitude toward them, that their sense of self-condemnation was a reflection of God's attitude toward them.

3. Covering, Adam and Eve made coverings for themselves in an effort to deal with their shame. Rather than turn to God for help with an expectation of mercy, the distorted view of God they now held drove them to self-dependence. Rather than seek forgiveness for their sin, they

attempted to manufacture a solution for themselves. All salvation-by-works religious systems have their origin here, in the psychological derangement of self-dependence that came upon humanity as a result of the Fall.

4. Hiding, In addition to manufacturing coverings for themselves, they were also now possessed of an impulse to hide from God. Again, on the premise of the lie they had believed regarding the character of God, it did not occur to them to expect compassion and acceptance from God. He was now imagined to be their enemy. So they hid. And human beings have been hiding from God ever since.

5. Blaming, Whereas before the Fall it came natural to live for one another, now it became their natural instinct to cast blame on one another, and ultimately upon God. And human beings have been blaming one another and God ever since that day. Blame-casting is a false survival tactic for dealing with shame. By blaming others, Adam and Eve did not have to face themselves and take responsibility for their actions.

Gen 3:15… the Good News Promise

John 1: 1-5…In Him was life**. 1:14** The word became flesh. Life begets life. A corn seed 2000yrs old will grow but the same compound made by science will not.

John 1: 29…The lamb; recalls the OT sacrifices which pointed to the self-sacrifice of God himself as the innocent one bearing the penalty of sin.

Romans 6: 23…and 3:23 Consequence of Sin is death! We must ask why? Is God being too extreme here? I mean, why should the wages of sin be so harsh? The answer lies in an understanding of who God is and what he provides for us. We may look at 2 texts to establish this.

John 3:16,17… 1. Makes sacrifice because he loves; not in order to love

2. Gods attitude is not one of condemnation, but pardoning love.

3. God saves by the self-sacrificing love of Jesus; his death on the cross.

Also, two problems: sin and death!

John 12:23-32… a heavy, deep passage, but the main point is simple: Jesus states the "purpose" of His death: to show who God really is!

#1 The cross reveals God's free forgiveness for our sins, thus lifting our **shame** and restoring our innocence before Him.

#2 The cross relieves our illegitimate **fear** of God by repainting His true character upon our hearts.

#3 The cross provides the true **covering** we need—the "love" of God that effectually "covers a multitude of sins" (1 Peter 4:8).

#4 The cross draws us to God out of our **hiding**—our obsessions, addictions, and every self-destructive behavior—into the light of His reassuring love.

#5 And the cross gives us the moral courage to cease **blaming** others and take responsibility for our sins through confession and repentance.

So we can see according to the scriptures, **God is the source of life**. Therefore a separation from God will automatically lead to a cessation of life. So we can see humanity has **two problems:**

1. Sin.

2. Death.

Matthew 20: 28… Ransom = price! **λύτρον** [*lutron* /**loo**·tron/]. The price for redeeming, ransom. How does that work?

Romans 5: 10… **Question:** According to this verse, by what are we reconciled? (reconnected)

Answer: The death of his Son.

Question: According to this verse, how are we saved?

Answer: By His life.

Explanation: Jesus died the death that I deserve thus paying my penalty and Jesus lived a life that I have not lived thus recommending me to God and thus saving me.

Illustration - Billionaires Club (You need something to join, familiar to all members)

Romans 10:9-13.. You believe that Jesus died the death that you deserve; and lived the life you should live.

Christ was treated as we deserve, that we might be treated as He deserves. He was condemned for our sins, in which He had no share, that we might be justified by His righteousness, in which we had no share. He suffered the death which was ours, that we might receive the life which was His. "With His stripes we are healed." (DOA p25)

Ephesians 2: 8-10… **Question:** According to verse 8, what are we saved through? And what are we saved by?

Answer: Faith & Grace.

Question: How do we get it?

Answer: It is a gift.

How do I receive this gift?

By your own strength you cannot turn from sin you can only turn to God to accept his will.

You can accept Jesus Christ right now in a S.N.A.P. (sinner,Need,Accept,Power)

Confess you are a **Sinner (Romans 3:23)**

Confess you have a **need** *only God can supply*

Accept *the Plan of Salvation*

Receive the **Power** *to live a new life given by Jesus Christ*

Give Steps to Christ Book

Appeal: Believers – affirm current belief; include self in appeal

Skeptics - invite to appreciate gift **if** it were true

Seekers – is there anything that would prevent you from calling on the name of the Lord today and being saved? What is it?

I want to affirm that your taking this decision seriously. What God has for you is far better than you can imagine.